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REVUE D'ÉTUDES ORIENTALES
TIJDSCHRIFT VOOR ORIËNTALISME

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CH. DE HARLEZ

SUBVENTIONNÉ PAR LE GOUVERNEMENT ET PAR LA FONDATION UNIVERSITAIRE
UITGEGEVEN MET STEUN VAN DE REGERING EN VAN DE UNIVERSITAIRE STICHTING

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LEUVEN

A FRAGMENT IN BOHAIRIC
ON ELISEUS THE HEGOUMENOS, FROM DAIR ABŪ MAQĀR

Half of a parchment leaf in the Bohairic dialect, probably of the eleventh century, is in the collection of MSS. of the Library of the Monastery of Saint Macarius (Dair Abū Maqār), in Wādī n-Naṭrūn. It is attached to MS. No. 576, which is a Commentary in Arabic by St-John Chrysostom on the Epistle to the Hebrews.

This leaf measures 25 × 17 cm., and the part occupied by the writing measures 18 and 17 × 15 cm.

The contents of this leaf relate to a certain saint named Eliseus to whom miracles are attributed. This saint may very possibly be Saint Eliseus, the hegoumenos of whom, beyond a simple commemoration in the Synaxarium and the Difnār, very little is known.

From the expression « he comes forth from the mountain with a brother », as well as from his title « hegoumenos », we may reasonably suppose that he was the superior of a monastery, probably, one in Upper Egypt.

The earliest extant copy of the Synaxarium, MS. 41 *a* Lit.¹ of the Coptic Museum (Old Cairo), gives the following reference on the 11th of the month of Hatūr :

وفيه ايضاً تذكار ارشلاوس الشهيد وفيه تذكار اليسع القمص صلاتها تكون
معنا امين

On it (11th Hatūr) again (is) the commemoration of Archilleus (Aršī-lāūs) the Martyr, and on it (is) the commemoration of Elisha (Alīša') the hegoumenos (al-Qummuṣ). May their prayers be with us! Amen.

¹ For the description of this MS., cf. MARCUS SIMAIKA PASHA and YASSĀ 'ABD AL-MASĪḥ, *Catalogue of the MSS. of the Coptic Museum*, vol. I (Cairo 1939), p. 70, No. 139, and G. GRAF, *Catalogue de manuscrits arabes chrétiens conservés au Caire (Studi e Testi, 63)*, Città del Vaticano, 1934, p. 23, No. 57.

The commemoration is also recorded on the same day in *Le Synaxaire arabe jacobite*, edited by R. Basset in *Patr. Orient.*, t. III, p. 279 [203], where, however, Eliseus is termed incorrectly « Elisha the Prophet » (اليشع النبي).

Saint Eliseus the hegoumenos is also mentioned in the *Guide to the Synaxarium* (دلال السنكسار); MS. 214 Lit.² of the Coptic Patriarchal Library which contains this Guide, states on foll. 13^v-14^r (new numeration foll. 198^v-199^r) the following : وفيه تذكار اليشع : القمص « On it (11th Hatūr) (is) the commemoration of Elisha (Alīša') the hegoumenos (al-Qummuṣ) ».

In the printed edition of this work, كتاب دليل السنكسار القبطي, edited by al-Qummuṣ Yūsuf Ḥabašī (القمص يوسف حبشي) (Cairo 1894), the name of this Saint is mentioned on p. 11 :

١١ (هاتور) نياحة حنه ام السيده مريم وتذكار القديس اليشع القمص

11th (Hatūr) the Dormition of Anna (Ḥannah) Mother of the Lady Mary (Maryam) and commemoration of the Saint Elisha (Alīša') the hegoumenos (al-Qummuṣ).

In the MS. 357 b Lit. of the Coptic Museum³ which contains the « Difnār for the Months of Hatūr and Kiyahk, Copto-Arabic », this Saint is mentioned on fol. 42^r :

ḤENPIAEZOY EΘY AQWPI NXEPHPMEYI NTENENIOT
N2YGOYMEHOC PINIOT ELICEOC TAW2 HPAC EZPHI.

On this holy day (11th Hatūr) is the commemoration of our father the great hegoumenos Eliseus (Eliseos). Pray to the Lord for (us), etc.

This Saint is also mentioned in BUDGE, *The Book of the Saints of the Ethiopian Church* (Cambridge 1928), vol. I, p. 231 : « And on this day also are commemorated Saint Archelaus the martyr, and Elisha the abbot. »

² For the description of this MS., cf. MARCUS SIMAIKA PASHA and YASSÄ 'ABD AL-MASIH, *Catalogue of the MSS. in the Library of the Coptic Patriarchate*, vol. II, fasc. I (Cairo 1942), p. 376, No. 835.

³ For the description of this MS., cf. MARCUS SIMAIKA etc., vol. I, fasc. I (Cairo 1939), p. 101, No. 214.

Recto

KEΓAP ΠAPEZANMHΘY †Z-ΘHO[Y] EPOT
EQNHOTY EBOA HENPIOTWOTY NEM-
OYCON EAPNKOT IE N-ΘOT EQHEN-
OYMA EQEP2WB NEMNICNHOTY N-
5 CEZITOY EPPI ZIXENTPKAZI ZIT-
ZH HMOQ
EYXW HMOZ XEAPIBON-ΘIN EPON MI-
POMI NTEPT OYOT NAIKEXW-
OYNI ON ΠAQTAΛBOTY NXEΠB
10 EBOA ZITOTQ IE HENPICAXI ETEQNA-
OYAZCAZNI HMOQ NWOY E-ΘPOY-
AIQ
EΘWΠ AE OYCZIMITE ΠACOTI EPATC
ZIFOTYI NTECTAMOT E[Π]ECΘWMI
15 ZITENPECZAI IE ZITENKEOTAI EQ-
HPI EPOT NGENOC OYOT ΠIPH
ETEQNAXOT NWOY ΠAYIPY KATA
ΠEQCAXI OYOT ΠAYOYXAI :

Verso

CLOT, NTETECMETPEQWAMΘENOYT
I EBOA HENXIMI THPQ NEMΠAEBOYN
ENIKE-ΘAYW
OYOT NEMAYINI NAQPE NZANMHΘY N-
4 POMI EYWONI HENZANWONI EYWE-
BHOYT OYOT EYOI NAEWON OYOT
ΠAQTAΛBOTY HENPIZMOT NTE-
ΠB ETWON NEMAQ NCHOY NIBEN EQEP-
ZWB NPHOTQ
10 ΦAI ETAQTWOTY HPEQBOK ELICEOC M-
PICHOY HENZANMHINI NEMZANWFH-
PI EMMON HPI TOI EPWOT HPEH-ΘO M-
ΠAΛOC THPQ
IH C ΠX C NCAQ NEMFOOTY N-ΘOT N-ΘOT
15 N-ΘOTPE NEMΠAENEZ EQWON HEN-
NH E-ΘOYAB NTAQ OYOT EQXOK EBOA

ἸΝΝΟΥΕΤΗΜΑ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΕΤΟΥΝΑΤΟΒΖ⁴
ΕΘΒΗΤΟΥ.

Recto

For (the) multitudes are wont to pay respect to him, as he comes forth from the mountain with a brother who has fallen asleep, or rather, when he is in a place working with the brethren, and they are wont to fall down upon the ground before him, saying: « *Help* us, man of God »; and these others also, the Lord is wont to heal, through him, or by the word which he commands them to perform. *But* if it be a woman, she is wont to stand at a distance and inform him of her illness through her husband or through another who is counted of her *race*, and as he tells them, so they are wont to do *according* to his word, and they are wont to be healed.

Verso

(The) fame⁵ of his service to God went forth in all Egypt and unto the Ethiopians also.

And they were wont to bring to him multitudes of people who were sick of diverse illnesses and (those) who were possessed of devils, and he was wont⁶ to heal them through the grace of the Lord which abode with him at all times, operating in him. He Who glorified His servant Eliseus (Eliseos) formerly with innumerable signs and wonders before all people, Jesus Christ, the same yesterday, and to day, and for ever⁷, abiding in His Saints, and fulfilling all their requests⁸ concerning which they beseech Him.

Babylon (Old Cairo),
Coptic Museum.

Yassā 'ABD AL-MASIḤ.

⁴ The letter *z* is written above *B*.

⁵ The Coptic text is not clear.

⁶ Coptic has present tense of custom.

⁷ *Heb.*, XIII, 8.

⁸ Cf. *Ps.* XIX, 6: ερεπῶς ξεκνεκῆτημα τηρου εβολ.

LA NOTICE DU SYNAXAIRE GÉORGIEN

SUR S. ORENTIUS

La légende de S. Orentius et de ses six frères, qui seraient morts martyrs dans différentes localités de la côte orientale de la mer Noire, n'est plus connue que par une notice du synaxaire, à la date du 24 juin¹. Feu le P. Peeters a montré que la Passion perdue résumée dans cette notice était une pure fiction, ne remontant probablement pas plus haut que le VIII^e ou le VII^e siècle, et sans la moindre attache avec aucun culte ni aucune tradition locale². Il note en terminant son étude (p. 262): « Comme la légende d'Orentius offrait à l'historiographie nationale des Ibères un thème fertile en variations érudites ou poétiques, on serait curieux de savoir quelle figure la notice du synaxaire grec a prise dans la version géorgienne »; n'ayant pu atteindre aucun manuscrit du synaxaire géorgien, le regretté bollandiste a dû se limiter à l'examen des « quelques bribes » de la notice géorgienne citées par M.-G. Ġanašvili d'après le manuscrit 222 du Musée Ecclésiastique de Tiflis³.

Nous avons trouvé la notice entière dans le manuscrit n° 4 du Sinaï, synaxaire en parchemin, du XII^e siècle environ, mutilé au début et à la fin, et s'étendant actuellement, avec quelques lacunes,

¹ Ed. H. DELEHAYE, *Synaxarium Ecclesiae Constantinopolitanae (Propylaeum ad Acta Sanctorum Novembris)*, Bruxelles, 1902, col. 767-768.

² P. PEETERS, *La légende de S. Orentius et de ses six frères martyrs*, dans *Anal. Boll.*, 56 (1938), p. 241-264; comp. *Martyrologium Romanum ... scholius historicis instructum (Propylaeum ad Acta Sanctorum Decembris)*, Bruxelles, 1940, p. 253, n° 4. — Plusieurs affirmations de détail, dans l'article du P. Peeters, appellent le *caute legendum* qu'il décerne, à juste titre, à la notice du synaxaire.

³ Art. cité, p. 263. Les mss du Musée Ecclésiastique se trouvent aujourd'hui au Musée de l'État à Tiflis; voir M. TARCHNIŠVILI, dans *Oriens Christianus*, 37 (1953), p. 94.